

Canonical murder facts

Grant Larceny dies from a botanical cardiac toxin in his private silver coupe. It was introduced in the Donor Salon, 6:40–6:49. One of the attending 15 core roles is selected through the blind animal draw. Optional roles cannot be selected.

All essential facts are heard in the three mandatory hearings. Each innocent has a signed, personally witnessed continuous alibi elsewhere. The murderer claims an elsewhere cover; their submitted card contradicts it with a timed, authenticated witness at the glass. All staff witnesses are fixed fictional people, independent of attendance.

The actual murder narrative and confession are never printed in the four active-play pages. The separate named FINALE envelope opens only after ballots are collected. All fixed clues work for every eligible murderer. Warning notes and flickering lights are human-made; no curse causes the death.

01 / Artie Ficial

Victim relationship: Grant had privately informed you that tonight's gift would come with a new governance agreement: he wanted veto power over acquisitions, his name on the museum, and your resignation within sixty days. You smiled through the meeting and told no one.

Hidden complication: You have already accepted a confidential offer to lead a rival museum next year, which makes any argument with Grant look like succession planning.

Innocent route: From 6:40 until 6:49 you remained at the museum office, working on a confidential job offer from a rival museum. An on-duty museum attendant checked your identity and watched you there continuously. You did not enter the Donor Salon in that window. The attendant is a fixed story witness, not a guest role.

Murderer route: At 6:47 you returned to the Donor Salon under the pretense of correcting Grant's speech cards. Furious at the takeover terms, you tipped

the stolen toxin into his private cordial and wiped the stem with your pocket square. You left calmly and resumed hosting.

Innocent evidence / Card B: Artie Ficial / ATTENDANT'S SIGNED RECORD: I checked this guest's identity and watched them continuously at the museum office, 6:40–6:49. Their activity concerned a confidential job offer from a rival museum. Earlier contact with salon objects cannot put them at the glass during this window.

Murderer evidence / Card A: Artie Ficial / SALON INCIDENT RECORD: At 6:47, the service attendant saw this guest at Grant's private silver coupe in the Donor Salon, handling a small vial beside the drink and wiping the stem. The attendant saw their face and museum badge. This contradicts their claim to have stayed at the museum office. The attendant's contemporaneous note has been authenticated.

02 / Claire O'Scuro

Victim relationship: You discovered that Grant knew the Star Bowl's provenance file contained a major gap and ordered the exhibition to proceed anyway. He threatened to remove you from the show if you raised the issue publicly.

Hidden complication: Against board instructions, you commissioned an independent provenance review and hid the preliminary report in the Registrar's Office.

Innocent route: From 6:40 until 6:49 you remained at the Registrar's scanning desk, working on an unauthorized independent provenance review. An on-duty museum attendant checked your identity and watched you there continuously. You did not enter the Donor Salon in that window. The attendant is a fixed story witness, not a guest role.

Murderer route: At 6:44 you used a label correction as an excuse to enter the Donor Salon. Believing Grant was about to lock dubious objects permanently into the museum, you poisoned his cordial and returned to the gallery before anyone noticed.

Innocent evidence / Card A: Claire O'Scuro / ATTENDANT'S SIGNED RECORD: I checked this guest's identity and watched them continuously at the Registrar's scanning desk, 6:40-6:49. Their activity concerned an unauthorized independent provenance review. Earlier contact with salon objects cannot put them at the glass during this window.

Murderer evidence / Card B: Claire O'Scuro / SALON INCIDENT RECORD: At 6:44, the service attendant saw this guest at Grant's private silver coupe in the Donor Salon, handling a small vial beside the drink and wiping the stem. The attendant saw their face and museum badge. This contradicts their claim to have stayed at the Registrar's scanning desk. The attendant's contemporaneous note has been authenticated.

03 / Hugh Bidder

Victim relationship: Grant had learned that one certificate in a major private sale you brokered was forged before it ever reached you. He planned to imply publicly that you had created it unless you refunded him millions.

Hidden complication: You were duped on that sale, but you quietly altered your own file afterward so clients would not see how badly your due diligence failed.

Innocent route: From 6:40 until 6:49 you remained at the Media Room document terminal, working on the sale file I altered after discovering the forged certificate. An on-duty museum attendant checked your identity and watched you there continuously. You did not enter the Donor Salon in that window. The attendant is a fixed story witness, not a guest role.

Murderer route: At 6:46 you returned with a revised appraisal folder. You used the lookalike decanter as cover while slipping the toxin directly into Grant's silver coupe, then wiped the stem before leaving.

Innocent evidence / Card B: Hugh Bidder / ATTENDANT'S SIGNED RECORD: I checked this guest's identity and watched them continuously at the Media Room document terminal, 6:40-6:49. Their activity concerned the sale file the guest altered after discovering the forged certificate. Earlier contact with salon objects cannot put them at the glass during this window.

Murderer evidence / Card A: Hugh Bidder / SALON INCIDENT RECORD: At 6:46, the service attendant saw this guest at Grant's private silver coupe in the Donor Salon, handling a small vial beside the drink and wiping the stem. The attendant saw their face and museum badge. This contradicts their claim to have stayed at the Media Room document terminal. The attendant's contemporaneous note has been authenticated.

04 / Monet Bags

Victim relationship: Grant demanded that you disguise several gala and naming-wing expenses inside restricted museum funds until his promised donation cleared. When you resisted, he threatened to blame the bookkeeping on you.

Hidden complication: You temporarily moved money between internal accounts to cover a cash-flow shortfall, intending to reverse it after the gala. It was technically unauthorized and Grant discovered it.

Innocent route: From 6:40 until 6:49 you remained at the finance office, working on an unauthorized internal transfer. An on-duty museum attendant checked your identity and watched you there continuously. You did not enter the Donor Salon in that window. The attendant is a fixed story witness, not a guest role.

Murderer route: At 6:45 you returned to obtain the signature Grant had withheld. When he mocked the accounting mess he had helped create, you poisoned his cordial. You then copied a budget sheet to create the impression your office visit happened earlier.

Innocent evidence / Card B: Monet Bags / ATTENDANT'S SIGNED RECORD: I checked this guest's identity and watched them continuously at the finance office, 6:40–6:49. Their activity concerned an unauthorized internal transfer. Earlier contact with salon objects cannot put them at the glass during this window.

Murderer evidence / Card A: Monet Bags / SALON INCIDENT RECORD: At 6:45, the service attendant saw this guest at Grant's private silver coupe in the Donor Salon, handling a small vial beside the drink and wiping the stem.

The attendant saw their face and museum badge. This contradicts their claim to have stayed at the finance office. The attendant's contemporaneous note has been authenticated.

05 / Chip Patina

Victim relationship: Grant pressured you to soften a conservation report showing that one supposedly untouched object had been recently altered. He threatened to replace you with a private conservator if you refused.

Hidden complication: You changed the date on a minor treatment record last month to spare the museum an embarrassing insurance dispute. No object was harmed, but the falsification could end your career.

Innocent route: From 6:40 until 6:49 you remained at the Conservation Lab, working on the treatment record whose date I changed. An on-duty museum attendant checked your identity and watched you there continuously. You did not enter the Donor Salon in that window. The attendant is a fixed story witness, not a guest role.

Murderer route: You took the toxin sample from the conservation cabinet earlier. At 6:43, while carrying a condition-report folder to Grant, you added it to his cordial and disposed of the stopper in your glove pouch.

Innocent evidence / Card A: Chip Patina / ATTENDANT'S SIGNED RECORD: I checked this guest's identity and watched them continuously at the Conservation Lab, 6:40–6:49. Their activity concerned the treatment record whose date the guest changed. Earlier contact with salon objects cannot put them at the glass during this window.

Murderer evidence / Card B: Chip Patina / SALON INCIDENT RECORD: At 6:43, the service attendant saw this guest at Grant's private silver coupe in the Donor Salon, handling a small vial beside the drink and wiping the stem. The attendant saw their face and museum badge. This contradicts their claim to have stayed at the Conservation Lab. The attendant's contemporaneous note has been authenticated.

06 / Dada DiCapo

Victim relationship: Grant appropriated the concept for one of your unreleased performances and planned to unveil a sanitized version of it as the gala's closing spectacle, crediting himself as creative patron.

Hidden complication: You wrote and planted the ominous anonymous warning note about 'returning what was taken.' It was meant as an art-world provocation, not a literal threat.

Innocent route: From 6:40 until 6:49 you remained at the Media Room print counter, working on copies of the warning note I planted for my performance. An on-duty museum attendant checked your identity and watched you there continuously. You did not enter the Donor Salon in that window. The attendant is a fixed story witness, not a guest role.

Murderer route: At 6:42 you carried a silver prop into the Donor Salon as cover. You used it to stir the toxin into Grant's cordial, wiped it, and returned to Faye only moments later.

Innocent evidence / Card B: Dada DiCapo / ATTENDANT'S SIGNED RECORD: I checked this guest's identity and watched them continuously at the Media Room print counter, 6:40–6:49. Their activity concerned copies of the warning note the guest planted for their performance. Earlier contact with salon objects cannot put them at the glass during this window.

Murderer evidence / Card A: Dada DiCapo / SALON INCIDENT RECORD: At 6:42, the service attendant saw this guest at Grant's private silver coupe in the Donor Salon, handling a small vial beside the drink and wiping the stem. The attendant saw their face and museum badge. This contradicts their claim to have stayed at the Media Room print counter. The attendant's contemporaneous note has been authenticated.

07 / Vincent Van Faux

Victim relationship: Grant owned an embarrassing student painting you have spent years trying to buy back. He planned to display it tonight beside your celebrated recent work as a joke about 'humble beginnings.'

Hidden complication: You have secretly used buyers to acquire several of your own early paintings so you could remove them from circulation. The art world would find that both vain and market-manipulative.

Innocent route: From 6:40 until 6:49 you remained at the Registrar's copier, working on proxy paperwork for buying back my own early paintings. An on-duty museum attendant checked your identity and watched you there continuously. You did not enter the Donor Salon in that window. The attendant is a fixed story witness, not a guest role.

Murderer route: At 6:44 you entered with a signed sketch for Grant. You poisoned the cordial and wiped the glass, but a fleck of your distinctive cobalt studio pigment transferred from your cuff to the stem.

Innocent evidence / Card A: Vincent Van Faux / ATTENDANT'S SIGNED RECORD: I checked this guest's identity and watched them continuously at the Registrar's copier, 6:40–6:49. Their activity concerned proxy paperwork for buying back their own early paintings. Earlier contact with salon objects cannot put them at the glass during this window.

Murderer evidence / Card B: Vincent Van Faux / SALON INCIDENT RECORD: At 6:44, the service attendant saw this guest at Grant's private silver coupe in the Donor Salon, handling a small vial beside the drink and wiping the stem. The attendant saw their face and museum badge. This contradicts their claim to have stayed at the Registrar's copier. The attendant's contemporaneous note has been authenticated.

08 / Sue Venir

Victim relationship: You wrote a private legal memorandum concluding that the Star Bowl's acquisition was too risky to defend confidently. Grant forced you to replace it with a softer opinion and planned to cite your name during the announcement.

Hidden complication: Both versions of the memo still exist. You kept the original instead of destroying it, which could expose you to professional embarrassment and Grant to serious scrutiny.

Innocent route: From 6:40 until 6:49 you remained at the Registrar's secure print desk, working on the original legal memo I was pressured to soften. An on-duty museum attendant checked your identity and watched you there continuously. You did not enter the Donor Salon in that window. The attendant is a fixed story witness, not a guest role.

Murderer route: At 6:46 you returned with the original memo and demanded Grant change his announcement. When he refused, you poisoned his cordial. A torn corner from your pad remained beneath the decanter.

Innocent evidence / Card A: Sue Venir / ATTENDANT'S SIGNED RECORD: I checked this guest's identity and watched them continuously at the Registrar's secure print desk, 6:40–6:49. Their activity concerned the original legal memo the guest was pressured to soften. Earlier contact with salon objects cannot put them at the glass during this window.

Murderer evidence / Card B: Sue Venir / SALON INCIDENT RECORD: At 6:46, the service attendant saw this guest at Grant's private silver coupe in the Donor Salon, handling a small vial beside the drink and wiping the stem. The attendant saw their face and museum badge. This contradicts their claim to have stayed at the Registrar's secure print desk. The attendant's contemporaneous note has been authenticated.

09 / Dr. Art E. Fact

Victim relationship: Grant suppressed your research showing that two objects in his collection passed through a dealer linked to questionable wartime sales. He threatened to release correspondence suggesting you had overstated another provenance claim if you challenged him publicly.

Hidden complication: One celebrated article of yours does contain an inference you stated too confidently. The main thesis still stands, but the mistake would be humiliating.

Innocent route: From 6:40 until 6:49 you remained at the Media Room archive scanner, working on correspondence showing the mistake in my published article. An on-duty museum attendant checked your identity and

watched you there continuously. You did not enter the Donor Salon in that window. The attendant is a fixed story witness, not a guest role.

Murderer route: At 6:45 you carried a research packet to Grant. You poisoned the cordial after he refused to release the acquisition files. One black-star seal from your packet adhered beneath the tray.

Innocent evidence / Card B: Dr. Art E. Fact / ATTENDANT'S SIGNED RECORD: I checked this guest's identity and watched them continuously at the Media Room archive scanner, 6:40–6:49. Their activity concerned correspondence showing the mistake in their published article. Earlier contact with salon objects cannot put them at the glass during this window.

Murderer evidence / Card A: Dr. Art E. Fact / SALON INCIDENT RECORD: At 6:45, the service attendant saw this guest at Grant's private silver coupe in the Donor Salon, handling a small vial beside the drink and wiping the stem. The attendant saw their face and museum badge. This contradicts their claim to have stayed at the Media Room archive scanner. The attendant's contemporaneous note has been authenticated.

10 / Tess Tament

Victim relationship: Grant told you he intended to rewrite the family trust tonight, removing you from control of the charitable foundation unless you publicly backed his museum naming plan.

Hidden complication: You have been quietly organizing other family trustees to block Grant's control over the foundation and redirect future giving toward worker and community programs.

Innocent route: From 6:40 until 6:49 you remained at the donor-office document desk, working on trust documents for the family challenge. An on-duty museum attendant checked your identity and watched you there continuously. You did not enter the Donor Salon in that window. The attendant is a fixed story witness, not a guest role.

Murderer route: You returned at 6:43 after learning the trust papers were ready. During the argument you slipped the toxin directly into Grant's silver coupe and scratched its base with your signet ring while steadying it.

Innocent evidence / Card A: Tess Tament / ATTENDANT'S SIGNED RECORD: I checked this guest's identity and watched them continuously at the donor-office document desk, 6:40–6:49. Their activity concerned trust documents for the family challenge. Earlier contact with salon objects cannot put them at the glass during this window.

Murderer evidence / Card B: Tess Tament / SALON INCIDENT RECORD: At 6:43, the service attendant saw this guest at Grant's private silver coupe in the Donor Salon, handling a small vial beside the drink and wiping the stem. The attendant saw their face and museum badge. This contradicts their claim to have stayed at the donor-office document desk. The attendant's contemporaneous note has been authenticated.

11 / Barb Dwyer

Victim relationship: Grant ordered you to disable the Donor Salon camera because he planned several off-the-record meetings. He then told you that if anything went wrong tonight, security would 'own the failure.'

Hidden complication: You personally unplugged the camera despite museum policy. You did it under direct donor pressure and never documented the order.

Innocent route: From 6:40 until 6:49 you remained at the security station, working on manual security checks after disabling the camera. An on-duty museum attendant checked your identity and watched you there continuously. You did not enter the Donor Salon in that window. The attendant is a fixed story witness, not a guest role.

Murderer route: You used your master key at 6:41 to re-enter the camera-blind salon. Furious that Grant planned to blame you for any problem, you poisoned his cordial and relied on the missing footage to protect you.

Innocent evidence / Card B: Barb Dwyer / ATTENDANT'S SIGNED RECORD: I checked this guest's identity and watched them continuously at the security station, 6:40–6:49. Their activity concerned manual security checks

after disabling the camera. Earlier contact with salon objects cannot put them at the glass during this window.

Murderer evidence / Card A: Barb Dwyer / SALON INCIDENT RECORD: At 6:41, the service attendant saw this guest at Grant's private silver coupe in the Donor Salon, handling a small vial beside the drink and wiping the stem. The attendant saw their face and museum badge. This contradicts their claim to have stayed at the security station. The attendant's contemporaneous note has been authenticated.

12 / Paige Turner

Victim relationship: You were preparing a major investigation into Grant's collection and labor empire. He discovered enough to threaten an injunction and promised to reveal the identity of one of your confidential museum sources if you published.

Hidden complication: You obtained internal documents through a source inside the Meridian. Protecting that source matters more to you than tonight's scoop.

Innocent route: From 6:40 until 6:49 you remained at the Press Room scanner, working on source documents behind my embargoed story. An on-duty museum attendant checked your identity and watched you there continuously. You did not enter the Donor Salon in that window. The attendant is a fixed story witness, not a guest role.

Murderer route: At 6:45 you returned after Grant threatened your source. You poisoned his cordial and then wrote a false earlier timestamp in your notebook to create distance from the salon.

Innocent evidence / Card A: Paige Turner / ATTENDANT'S SIGNED RECORD: I checked this guest's identity and watched them continuously at the Press Room scanner, 6:40-6:49. Their activity concerned source documents behind their embargoed story. Earlier contact with salon objects cannot put them at the glass during this window.

Murderer evidence / Card B: Paige Turner / SALON INCIDENT RECORD: At 6:45, the service attendant saw this guest at Grant's private silver coupe in

the Donor Salon, handling a small vial beside the drink and wiping the stem. The attendant saw their face and museum badge. This contradicts their claim to have stayed at the Press Room scanner. The attendant's contemporaneous note has been authenticated.

13 / Frank Lloyd Wrong

Victim relationship: Grant demanded a dangerous last-minute change to the centerpiece display and threatened to withhold your firm's final payment if you refused. He also planned to blame you publicly for any flaw in the opening-night presentation.

Hidden complication: You signed off on one temporary lighting rig that did not fully meet your own design standard because there was no time to rebuild it before the gala.

Innocent route: From 6:40 until 6:49 you remained at the Grand Gallery lighting console, working on adjustments to an unapproved temporary lighting rig. An on-duty museum attendant checked your identity and watched you there continuously. You did not enter the Donor Salon in that window. The attendant is a fixed story witness, not a guest role.

Murderer route: At 6:46 you used a lighting check as cover to enter the salon. You poisoned Grant's cordial and accidentally left your distinctive brass screwdriver near the service tray.

Innocent evidence / Card B: Frank Lloyd Wrong / ATTENDANT'S SIGNED RECORD: I checked this guest's identity and watched them continuously at the Grand Gallery lighting console, 6:40–6:49. Their activity concerned adjustments to an unapproved temporary lighting rig. Earlier contact with salon objects cannot put them at the glass during this window.

Murderer evidence / Card A: Frank Lloyd Wrong / SALON INCIDENT RECORD: At 6:46, the service attendant saw this guest at Grant's private silver coupe in the Donor Salon, handling a small vial beside the drink and wiping the stem. The attendant saw their face and museum badge. This contradicts their claim to have stayed at the Grand Gallery lighting console. The attendant's contemporaneous note has been authenticated.

14 / Mona Lott

Victim relationship: Grant intended to announce that the Star Bowl would become a permanent Meridian holding, undermining months of quiet restitution negotiations and publicly humiliating the international partners you represent.

Hidden complication: You leaked the existence of the restitution talks to selected journalists to pressure Grant, even though the negotiations were supposed to remain confidential.

Innocent route: From 6:40 until 6:49 you remained at the Registrar's fax desk, working on a confidential restitution packet. An on-duty museum attendant checked your identity and watched you there continuously. You did not enter the Donor Salon in that window. The attendant is a fixed story witness, not a guest role.

Murderer route: At 6:44 you returned with a second envelope containing a final demand. When Grant refused, you poisoned the cordial. You discarded the envelope after it picked up a drop from the drink.

Innocent evidence / Card A: Mona Lott / ATTENDANT'S SIGNED RECORD: I checked this guest's identity and watched them continuously at the Registrar's fax desk, 6:40–6:49. Their activity concerned a confidential restitution packet. Earlier contact with salon objects cannot put them at the glass during this window.

Murderer evidence / Card B: Mona Lott / SALON INCIDENT RECORD: At 6:44, the service attendant saw this guest at Grant's private silver coupe in the Donor Salon, handling a small vial beside the drink and wiping the stem. The attendant saw their face and museum badge. This contradicts their claim to have stayed at the Registrar's fax desk. The attendant's contemporaneous note has been authenticated.

15 / Elon Mosaic

Victim relationship: Grant had blacklisted you from a major acquisition after you outbid him anonymously for a work he wanted. Tonight he planned to announce that your collecting practices were 'speculative theater' and block your appointment to the museum board.

Hidden complication: You were the anonymous buyer in the auction incident everyone keeps referencing. You concealed your identity through Hugh to avoid a bidding war with Grant.

Innocent route: From 6:40 until 6:49 you remained at the collection scanning desk, working on the invoice identifying me as the anonymous bidder. An on-duty museum attendant checked your identity and watched you there continuously. You did not enter the Donor Salon in that window. The attendant is a fixed story witness, not a guest role.

Murderer route: At 6:48 you slipped into the Donor Salon to force a reconciliation before the announcement. You poisoned the cordial when Grant refused. Your glass cufflink struck the service table and chipped; one fragment remained on the carpet.

Innocent evidence / Card B: Elon Mosaic / ATTENDANT'S SIGNED RECORD: I checked this guest's identity and watched them continuously at the collection scanning desk, 6:40–6:49. Their activity concerned the invoice identifying them as the anonymous bidder. Earlier contact with salon objects cannot put them at the glass during this window.

Murderer evidence / Card A: Elon Mosaic / SALON INCIDENT RECORD: At 6:48, the service attendant saw this guest at Grant's private silver coupe in the Donor Salon, handling a small vial beside the drink and wiping the stem. The attendant saw their face and museum badge. This contradicts their claim to have stayed at the collection scanning desk. The attendant's contemporaneous note has been authenticated.

16 / Anya Tique

Victim relationship: Grant planned to reveal that you accepted his first questionable donation in 1989 despite incomplete paperwork, staining the legacy you built.

Hidden complication: You did approve that accession because the museum was desperate for funds and you convinced yourself the paperwork would follow.

Innocent route: An on-duty attendant checked your identity and watched you continuously at the Grand Gallery bench from 6:40 to 6:49. You were not in the Donor Salon. This fixed staff witness is not another guest and does not establish any other guest's location.

Murderer route: This role is not eligible in the standard animal draw.

Innocent evidence / Card A: Anya Tique / STAFF RECORD: The on-duty attendant confirms continuous personal presence at the Grand Gallery bench, 6:40–6:49. No other guest's whereabouts are certified by this record.

Murderer evidence / Card B: Anya Tique / STAFF RECORD: The on-duty attendant confirms continuous personal presence at the Grand Gallery bench, 6:40–6:49. No other guest's whereabouts are certified by this record.

17 / Saul D. Bid

Victim relationship: Grant threatened to expose a private sale you arranged outside your auction house's normal process unless you waived a substantial fee.

Hidden complication: You did route the sale through a discreet subsidiary to satisfy a client who insisted on anonymity.

Innocent route: An on-duty attendant checked your identity and watched you continuously at the auction catalogue desk from 6:40 to 6:49. You were not in the Donor Salon. This fixed staff witness is not another guest and does not establish any other guest's location.

Murderer route: This role is not eligible in the standard animal draw.

Innocent evidence / Card B: Saul D. Bid / STAFF RECORD: The on-duty attendant confirms continuous personal presence at the auction catalogue desk, 6:40–6:49. No other guest's whereabouts are certified by this record.

Murderer evidence / Card A: Saul D. Bid / STAFF RECORD: The on-duty attendant confirms continuous personal presence at the auction catalogue desk, 6:40–6:49. No other guest's whereabouts are certified by this record.

18 / Elle Loominate

Victim relationship: Grant intended to purchase a family-owned ceremonial textile you had borrowed for your installation, despite your refusal to sell.

Hidden complication: The textile is in the exhibition without the full paperwork your family expected because you were afraid the loan would be denied.

Innocent route: An on-duty attendant checked your identity and watched you continuously at the textile display from 6:40 to 6:49. You were not in the Donor Salon. This fixed staff witness is not another guest and does not establish any other guest's location.

Murderer route: This role is not eligible in the standard animal draw.

Innocent evidence / Card A: Elle Loominate / STAFF RECORD: The on-duty attendant confirms continuous personal presence at the textile display, 6:40–6:49. No other guest's whereabouts are certified by this record.

Murderer evidence / Card B: Elle Loominate / STAFF RECORD: The on-duty attendant confirms continuous personal presence at the textile display, 6:40–6:49. No other guest's whereabouts are certified by this record.

19 / Reed DeLabel

Victim relationship: You found an archival document that contradicted the Star Bowl label. Grant told your department your fellowship could disappear if you pushed it.

Hidden complication: You have not yet told Art that your discovery also undermines one sentence in his published research.

Innocent route: An on-duty attendant checked your identity and watched you continuously at the education workroom from 6:40 to 6:49. You were not in the Donor Salon. This fixed staff witness is not another guest and does not establish any other guest's location.

Murderer route: This role is not eligible in the standard animal draw.

Innocent evidence / Card B: Reed DeLabel / STAFF RECORD: The on-duty attendant confirms continuous personal presence at the education workroom, 6:40–6:49. No other guest's whereabouts are certified by this record.

Murderer evidence / Card A: Reed DeLabel / STAFF RECORD: The on-duty attendant confirms continuous personal presence at the education workroom, 6:40–6:49. No other guest's whereabouts are certified by this record.

20 / Al Baster

Victim relationship: Grant planned to replace your commissioned entrance sculpture with a cheaper replica after the opening and dispute your final payment.

Hidden complication: You built one internal support differently from the approved plan because the fabricator missed a deadline.

Innocent route: An on-duty attendant checked your identity and watched you continuously at the sculpture preparation bay from 6:40 to 6:49. You were not in the Donor Salon. This fixed staff witness is not another guest and does not establish any other guest's location.

Murderer route: This role is not eligible in the standard animal draw.

Innocent evidence / Card A: Al Baster / STAFF RECORD: The on-duty attendant confirms continuous personal presence at the sculpture preparation bay, 6:40–6:49. No other guest's whereabouts are certified by this record.

Murderer evidence / Card B: Al Baster / STAFF RECORD: The on-duty attendant confirms continuous personal presence at the sculpture

preparation bay, 6:40–6:49. No other guest's whereabouts are certified by this record.

21 / Ella Gance

Victim relationship: Grant knew you quietly sold a work you had publicly promised to donate to another institution and planned to expose the contradiction.

Hidden complication: You sold it to cover a failed business investment and hoped to replace it before anyone noticed.

Innocent route: An on-duty attendant checked your identity and watched you continuously at the coat-check lounge from 6:40 to 6:49. You were not in the Donor Salon. This fixed staff witness is not another guest and does not establish any other guest's location.

Murderer route: This role is not eligible in the standard animal draw.

Innocent evidence / Card B: Ella Gance / STAFF RECORD: The on-duty attendant confirms continuous personal presence at the coat-check lounge, 6:40–6:49. No other guest's whereabouts are certified by this record.

Murderer evidence / Card A: Ella Gance / STAFF RECORD: The on-duty attendant confirms continuous personal presence at the coat-check lounge, 6:40–6:49. No other guest's whereabouts are certified by this record.

22 / Drew Conclusions

Victim relationship: Grant discovered that you write an anonymous satirical newsletter skewering museum patrons and planned to unmask you during his speech.

Hidden complication: Several jokes in the newsletter came from private conversations, and you regret at least one of them.

Innocent route: An on-duty attendant checked your identity and watched you continuously at the podcast recording booth from 6:40 to 6:49. You were not in the Donor Salon. This fixed staff witness is not another guest and does not establish any other guest's location.

Murderer route: This role is not eligible in the standard animal draw.

Innocent evidence / Card A: Drew Conclusions / STAFF RECORD: The on-duty attendant confirms continuous personal presence at the podcast recording booth, 6:40–6:49. No other guest's whereabouts are certified by this record.

Murderer evidence / Card B: Drew Conclusions / STAFF RECORD: The on-duty attendant confirms continuous personal presence at the podcast recording booth, 6:40–6:49. No other guest's whereabouts are certified by this record.

23 / Brie DeVivre

Victim relationship: Grant had refused to approve the final catering invoice and planned to blame you for a last-minute service change he personally ordered.

Hidden complication: You changed his private beverage setup twice because Grant and his assistant gave contradictory instructions.

Innocent route: An on-duty attendant checked your identity and watched you continuously at the buffet kitchen from 6:40 to 6:49. You were not in the Donor Salon. This fixed staff witness is not another guest and does not establish any other guest's location.

Murderer route: This role is not eligible in the standard animal draw.

Innocent evidence / Card B: Brie DeVivre / STAFF RECORD: The on-duty attendant confirms continuous personal presence at the buffet kitchen, 6:40–6:49. No other guest's whereabouts are certified by this record.

Murderer evidence / Card A: Brie DeVivre / STAFF RECORD: The on-duty attendant confirms continuous personal presence at the buffet kitchen, 6:40–6:49. No other guest's whereabouts are certified by this record.

24 / Cary Crates

Victim relationship: Grant saw you damage a minor frame during installation and threatened to have you fired after the gala, despite the damage being repairable.

Hidden complication: You concealed the crack with a reversible mount until Chip could inspect it after opening night.

Innocent route: An on-duty attendant checked your identity and watched you continuously at the loading-bay worktable from 6:40 to 6:49. You were not in the Donor Salon. This fixed staff witness is not another guest and does not establish any other guest's location.

Murderer route: This role is not eligible in the standard animal draw.

Innocent evidence / Card A: Cary Crates / STAFF RECORD: The on-duty attendant confirms continuous personal presence at the loading-bay worktable, 6:40–6:49. No other guest's whereabouts are certified by this record.

Murderer evidence / Card B: Cary Crates / STAFF RECORD: The on-duty attendant confirms continuous personal presence at the loading-bay worktable, 6:40–6:49. No other guest's whereabouts are certified by this record.

25 / Anne E. Dote

Victim relationship: Grant's gift conditions would cut public education programming to fund a private donor lounge and VIP entrance.

Hidden complication: You organized an anonymous staff petition against the plan and slipped copies into trustee folders.

Innocent route: An on-duty attendant checked your identity and watched you continuously at the school-tour display from 6:40 to 6:49. You were not in the Donor Salon. This fixed staff witness is not another guest and does not establish any other guest's location.

Murderer route: This role is not eligible in the standard animal draw.

Innocent evidence / Card B: Anne E. Dote / STAFF RECORD: The on-duty attendant confirms continuous personal presence at the school-tour display, 6:40–6:49. No other guest's whereabouts are certified by this record.

Murderer evidence / Card A: Anne E. Dote / STAFF RECORD: The on-duty attendant confirms continuous personal presence at the school-tour display, 6:40–6:49. No other guest's whereabouts are certified by this record.

26 / Faye Stop

Victim relationship: Grant ordered you to surrender a photograph showing him meeting privately with Hugh beside a shell-company shipping file.

Hidden complication: You kept a backup print after agreeing to delete the image from your camera.

Innocent route: An on-duty attendant checked your identity and watched you continuously at the portrait backdrop from 6:40 to 6:49. You were not in the Donor Salon. This fixed staff witness is not another guest and does not establish any other guest's location.

Murderer route: This role is not eligible in the standard animal draw.

Innocent evidence / Card A: Faye Stop / STAFF RECORD: The on-duty attendant confirms continuous personal presence at the portrait backdrop, 6:40–6:49. No other guest's whereabouts are certified by this record.

Murderer evidence / Card B: Faye Stop / STAFF RECORD: The on-duty attendant confirms continuous personal presence at the portrait backdrop, 6:40–6:49. No other guest's whereabouts are certified by this record.

27 / Robin Banks

Victim relationship: Grant had you removed from a previous museum event and threatened legal action if you disrupted tonight's unveiling.

Hidden complication: You planted small 'PROVENANCE IS A VERB' stickers in several gallery brochures for a peaceful protest.

Innocent route: An on-duty attendant checked your identity and watched you continuously at the guest petition desk from 6:40 to 6:49. You were not in the Donor Salon. This fixed staff witness is not another guest and does not establish any other guest's location.

Murderer route: This role is not eligible in the standard animal draw.

Innocent evidence / Card B: Robin Banks / STAFF RECORD: The on-duty attendant confirms continuous personal presence at the guest petition desk, 6:40–6:49. No other guest's whereabouts are certified by this record.

Murderer evidence / Card A: Robin Banks / STAFF RECORD: The on-duty attendant confirms continuous personal presence at the guest petition desk, 6:40–6:49. No other guest's whereabouts are certified by this record.

28 / Penny Pincher

Victim relationship: One decorative object in the exhibition once belonged to your family. You believe Grant acquired it through a manipulative private sale decades ago.

Hidden complication: You brought old correspondence proving your family contested that sale and planned to confront him tonight.

Innocent route: An on-duty attendant checked your identity and watched you continuously at the collector lounge from 6:40 to 6:49. You were not in the Donor Salon. This fixed staff witness is not another guest and does not establish any other guest's location.

Murderer route: This role is not eligible in the standard animal draw.

Innocent evidence / Card A: Penny Pincher / STAFF RECORD: The on-duty attendant confirms continuous personal presence at the collector lounge, 6:40–6:49. No other guest's whereabouts are certified by this record.

Murderer evidence / Card B: Penny Pincher / STAFF RECORD: The on-duty attendant confirms continuous personal presence at the collector lounge, 6:40–6:49. No other guest's whereabouts are certified by this record.

29 / Justin Tyme

Victim relationship: Grant fed you several flattering claims for an earlier profile that you later discovered were exaggerated. He threatened to cut off access if you corrected them.

Hidden complication: You are preparing a correction that will also make you look embarrassingly credulous.

Innocent route: An on-duty attendant checked your identity and watched you continuously at the local-history display from 6:40 to 6:49. You were not in the Donor Salon. This fixed staff witness is not another guest and does not establish any other guest's location.

Murderer route: This role is not eligible in the standard animal draw.

Innocent evidence / Card B: Justin Tyme / STAFF RECORD: The on-duty attendant confirms continuous personal presence at the local-history display, 6:40–6:49. No other guest's whereabouts are certified by this record.

Murderer evidence / Card A: Justin Tyme / STAFF RECORD: The on-duty attendant confirms continuous personal presence at the local-history display, 6:40–6:49. No other guest's whereabouts are certified by this record.

30 / Minnie Malist

Victim relationship: Grant ordered you to add a gaudy lighting cue to the unveiling and threatened to withhold payment when Frank objected.

Hidden complication: You secretly changed the cue again after approval, causing the eerie light flickers guests noticed during Act I.

Innocent route: An on-duty attendant checked your identity and watched you continuously at the event-control desk from 6:40 to 6:49. You were not in the Donor Salon. This fixed staff witness is not another guest and does not establish any other guest's location.

Murderer route: This role is not eligible in the standard animal draw.

Innocent evidence / Card A: Minnie Malist / STAFF RECORD: The on-duty attendant confirms continuous personal presence at the event-control desk, 6:40–6:49. No other guest's whereabouts are certified by this record.

Murderer evidence / Card B: Minnie Malist / STAFF RECORD: The on-duty attendant confirms continuous personal presence at the event-control desk, 6:40–6:49. No other guest's whereabouts are certified by this record.

Difficulty & continuity

The motive hearing makes every grievance public; the whereabouts hearing supplies claims; the evidence hearing tests them. No essential evidence may be withheld. The selected murderer has one contradiction, while every innocent has a verified continuous elsewhere alibi. The puzzle is deliberately accessible to casual guests. Optional guests have independent staff alibis and do not certify another guest's whereabouts. Scavenger finds add atmosphere and motive context but cannot block solving.